

Nsw Education Ewaste Dubbo Laptops

Source type: Full DubboEwaste repository document

Repository path: docs/NSW-EDUCATION-EWASTE-DUBBO-LAPTOPS.md

Source commit: 77fee57f8ae6

NSW public-school eWaste — what happens to old Dubbo education laptops?

Research date: 2 October 2026

Scope: NSW Department of Education public schools in Dubbo/Orana, not private or independent schools.

Status: detailed public-source trace. The current contracted vendor and physical downstream facility for Dubbo-collected school laptops remain unpublished.

2 October 2026 qualification: the operational guide's school-wiping wording differs from the current policy's pre-disposal wiping requirement. Confirm the applicable preparation steps with Education's Digital Field/EDConnect team; the guide is not authority to override policy or release unwiped equipment. A later open of the guide URL redirected to Technology for Learning, so its current location/applicability also needs confirmation. See the prospect research (DUBBO-DEVICE-DISPOSAL-PROSPECTS.md) and evidence EVD-DISPOSAL-023-024 in data/evidence.yaml (../data/evidence.yaml).

Executive answer

Old laptops from NSW public schools in Dubbo do not simply go into the Dubbo Council/Whylandra/AMR household e-waste stream.

The Department has a separate, dedicated eWaste disposal process for school digital assets.

The current public workflow is:

school identifies equipment for disposal → correct approvals → eWaste PowerApp/EDConnect request → vendor creates a cost-efficient regional collection schedule → vendor collects from the school → vendor sanitises all collected hard drives → vendor issues a data-sanitisation certificate → vendor issues a Settlement Report → asset outcome after that is not publicly disclosed in the school guide

Two important things follow:

1. The operational guide assigns final hard-drive sanitisation and evidence to the vendor, while saying schools need not perform hard-drive wiping/destruction. The current policy also requires pre-disposal wiping. The applicable school preparation steps therefore need Department confirmation; do not infer permission to release unwiped equipment.
2. The public documents do not prove that every collected laptop is destroyed. NSW Government's current end-user-device contract allows reuse by sale/donation, reinsertion into supply chains, or recycling. But no public source currently proves which outcome is applied to Dubbo public-school laptops under the dedicated Education contract.

So the most important missing link is:

Who is the current NSW Education eWaste vendor, where do Dubbo school laptops physically go, and what percentage are reused/remarketed versus recycled or destroyed?

1. Current Department policy

The NSW Department of Education's Technology in schools procedures were updated on 18 June 2026.

Under section 3.2, principals must:

- recycle devices responsibly
- keep records of disposed/deactivated equipment
- ensure memory/data is correctly wiped.

The policy then says:

The department has a dedicated eWaste contract in place to manage the secure disposal of department digital assets.

Schools access that service through EDConnect to request an eWaste collection.

The same policy also tells schools to arrange redistribution of unused department-allocated devices for students in need by contacting the Department's ICT refresh team.

That establishes two distinct pathways:

Before disposal

If a Department-allocated device is still useful and unused, it can be redistributed within the education system.

Once being disposed

The device goes into the Department's dedicated eWaste/secure-disposal process.

Source:

<https://education.nsw.gov.au/policy-library/policies/pd-2024-0481-01>

2. The eWaste PowerApp / EDConnect workflow

The Department's current eWaste Application User Guide gives the most detailed public description of what the school and vendor actually do.

The guide says the school/support office must:

1. take stock of the items to be eWasted
2. complete the eWaste form
3. liaise with the vendor about collection date
4. move the equipment to a central accessible location
5. provide vendor access on collection day
6. sign off once everything is collected
7. keep the vendor's Settlement Report.

The guide then explicitly states:

Wiping / Destruction of Hard Drives is no longer required

for the school/support office.

The vendor is required to:

1. receive the collection request
2. plan a cost-efficient collection schedule
3. communicate with the school
4. collect the eWaste
5. data sanitise all hard drives collected
6. provide a Certificate of data sanitisation
7. provide a Settlement Report.

The form asks schools to estimate quantities so that the correct-size team and truck can be arranged.

That looks like a centrally managed regional asset-disposition/logistics service, not an ad-hoc trip to a local Council tip.

Source:

<https://t4l.schools.nsw.gov.au/content/dam/doe/sws/schools/t/t4l/pdfs/DOE25-eWasteApplicationInstructions.pdf>

Program contact shown in the public guide:

cor0835r8406.schoolsinfra@det.nsw.edu.au

3. Apparent wording tension: school wipe vs vendor wipe

There is a genuine public-document tension:

Technology in schools policy

Says configuration and storage must be securely wiped prior to disposal and principals must ensure memory/data is correctly wiped.

eWaste Application User Guide

Says:

Wiping / Destruction of Hard Drives is no longer required

for the school, while the vendor must sanitise all collected hard drives and provide a certificate.

The guide describes vendor sanitisation, but the public wording does not resolve which preparation steps the school must complete under the current policy. Confirm these with Education's Digital Field/EDConnect team before collection. The school remains accountable for authorised decommissioning and Department configuration/data handling.

Do not interpret the operational guide as meaning schools can casually hand untracked equipment to anyone.

The dedicated contract and settlement/certification workflow is what provides the controlled disposal pathway.

4. 2025 backlog proves the service is actively used

A June 2025 Technology for Learning update told schools that:

- many schools were confused about available eWaste collection
- storerooms had filled with old/outdated computer equipment
- the Department had formalised the process

- there was a backlog of schools requesting eWaste collection
- the Department was working with the vendor to clear the backlog.

This confirms:

- the dedicated service is not merely a policy placeholder
- there is meaningful statewide volume
- collections are being managed centrally through a vendor.

The update still did not name the vendor.

Source:

<https://education.nsw.gov.au/teaching-and-learning/technology-for-learning/news-t4l/2025/issue122>

5. What happens after sanitisation?

This is the main unresolved step.

The school eWaste guide stops after:

collection → sanitisation certificate → settlement report

It does not publish:

- testing/grading
- resale
- donation
- parts harvesting
- destruction
- material-recycling destination
- residual-value credit
- percentage reused
- percentage recycled.

Therefore it is incorrect to say either:

“Dubbo school laptops are shredded”

or:

“Dubbo school laptops are all refurbished and resold.”

Neither has been proven publicly.

6. NSW Government contract 9826 shows the permitted disposal options

The current ICT End User Devices and Services Contract 9826 runs:

1 October 2023 – 30 September 2028

and was updated on 23 September 2026.

It is the mandatory whole-of-government end-user-device contract.

Its disposal-service scope includes:

- validating whether equipment is operational/non-operational
- recovery from customer sites
- confirming sanitisation
- updating asset registers
- environmentally appropriate disposal.

Critically, the contract says disposal methods may include:

- reuse through donation or sale
- direct recovery and reinsertion into a supplier's supply chain
- recycling through a proven third-party channel
- environmental certification for recycled items.

It also says devices cannot be sent offshore for service/disposal without sanitisation first.

Source:

<https://www.info.buy.nsw.gov.au/contracts/ict-end-user-devices-and-services>

Important qualification

The Department of Education says it has a dedicated eWaste contract.

Public sources do not currently prove:

- that the school eWaste arrangement is an order under Contract 9826
- or that its dedicated vendor is one of the standalone disposal suppliers on 9826.

Therefore 9826 proves the NSW Government's accepted ITAD/disposal methods, but not the exact Education downstream outcome.

7. Current approved standalone disposal suppliers under Contract 9826

As at the current 2026 contract page, approved suppliers for Lot 2 standalone services include:

- ACT Logistics Pty Ltd
- G1 Asset Management Pty Ltd
- Greenbox Group Pty Ltd
- Industry Trading Unit Trust / Lifecycle Plus
- Sims E-Recycling Pty Ltd / Sims Lifecycle Services
- WorkVentures Ltd

These suppliers can provide standalone end-user-device services under the whole-of-government contract.

Source:

What this does NOT prove

It does not identify which supplier has the dedicated NSW Education schools eWaste contract.

I found no current public award notice that definitively links one of these suppliers to the statewide EDConnect school eWaste service.

8. ACT Logistics lead — useful but not proof

ACT Logistics is currently an approved standalone-services supplier under Contract 9826.

NSW public procurement also shows other agencies using ACT Logistics for:

- ICT equipment retrieval
- disposal
- asset lifecycle management.

For example, the Department of Primary Industries and Regional Development awarded a 2025-27 contract to ACT Logistics for those services.

Source:

<https://buy.nsw.gov.au/notices/08711EC5-DE37-4296-85BA5DE72801AE34>

This makes ACT Logistics a plausible Education vendor candidate, but:

there is no current public evidence in this research that ACT Logistics is the dedicated statewide NSW public-school eWaste vendor.

Do not present it as fact.

9. Could Sims or WorkVentures be the vendor?

Both are also approved standalone-service suppliers on Contract 9826.

Sims Lifecycle Services

Has large-scale ITAD/recycling capability and appears elsewhere in NSW Government/regional e-waste arrangements.

WorkVentures

Has secure refurbishment/social-reuse capability and now operates the NSW Device Bank pilot.

But again:

no public source found identifies either as the current EDConnect schools eWaste vendor.

The vendor remains unknown.

10. NSW Device Bank — similar process, separate program

The NSW Device Bank launched in 2026 to take surplus NSW Government laptops and:

- securely sanitise them
- test/grade/refurbish suitable devices
- redistribute devices to people facing digital exclusion
- appropriately dispose of non-viable equipment.

WorkVentures is the delivery partner for the pilot.

The public tender disclosed approximately:

- 2,800 laptops already in storage at the start
- 2,500 additional laptops expected during the 12-month term
- mostly HP EliteBook x360 1030 G3/G4
- some G7/G8
- most expected to be five years old or older.

Source:

<https://buy.nsw.gov.au/prcOpportunity/9A339589-49D9-448D-9A06E56260BBFA42>

Critical gap

No public evidence found that normal NSW public-school devices booked through the school EDConnect eWaste contract are routed to the NSW Device Bank.

These may be separate government asset streams.

This is a highly worthwhile question to ask Education.

11. What probably happens physically to a Dubbo school collection?

Only the first part can be stated with confidence.

Verified

A Dubbo public school:

1. inventories the devices
2. obtains the required approvals
3. submits the eWaste application
4. gives estimated quantities
5. the vendor plans a cost-efficient collection schedule
6. the vendor arranges a suitably sized collection team/truck
7. vendor collects from the school
8. vendor sanitises all hard drives
9. vendor issues certification and settlement report.

Strong operational inference

Because the vendor explicitly plans cost-efficient schedules and teams/trucks, regional schools are likely batched into regional collection runs rather than each school selecting its own local Dubbo recycler.

Not verified

The public record does not identify:

- regional consolidation depot
- truck operator
- Dubbo/Orange/Sydney transfer point
- first processing warehouse
- testing/refurbishment facility
- recycler
- final commodity destinations.

Do not draw a line from a Dubbo school to AMR/Whylandra/Matthews unless Education or the vendor confirms it.

12. Does a school principal have authority to give Dubbo eWaste the old laptops?

For Department digital assets going through the official disposal process, the answer should be treated as no, not casually.

The Department has:

- asset/equipment records
- disposal approval requirements
- a dedicated eWaste contract
- an EDConnect/PowerApp collection process
- controlled data sanitisation/certification.

A local school should not simply hand Department devices to an outside recycler/refurbisher outside that framework.

Therefore the Phase 0 pitch to a NSW public school should not be:

“Give Dubbo eWaste your old laptops instead.”

The future opportunity is more likely:

- become an approved/contracted service provider
- become a subcontractor to the existing vendor
- propose a Department-approved regional reuse pilot
- or integrate with an approved Device Bank/reuse pathway.

13. What this means for Dubbo eWaste

The schools finding changes the supply strategy.

Not a Phase 0 free-stock source

NSW public schools are not a simple donation source.

But a high-value future institutional market

A credible future Dubbo eWaste service could offer exactly the attributes the Department already requires:

- asset inventory
- chain of custody
- secure data sanitisation
- certificate/report
- testing/grading
- reuse-before-recycling
- environmentally appropriate residual recycling.

The long-term opportunity is to show that a regional reuse-first provider can:

1. reduce freight
2. identify reusable equipment before it becomes material recycling
3. create local refurbished-device supply
4. provide transparent asset-level reporting
5. hand only genuinely non-viable material to an approved recycler.

That is an institutional ITAD proposition, not ordinary public e-waste collection.

14. The Settlement Report may contain the missing answer

The public guide requires the vendor to provide a Settlement Report, but no sample was found publicly.

That report is potentially the best evidence for:

- asset ID
- serial number
- model
- sanitisation outcome
- accepted/rejected status
- grade
- resale/remarketing value
- recycling outcome
- destruction outcome
- residual-value credit.

Those fields are not confirmed because the template has not been published.

A redacted/blank Settlement Report should be specifically requested.

15. Exact information request that would close the Dubbo school gap

Request the following from NSW Department of Education / School Infrastructure / information access:

Contract identity

1. Name and ABN of the current dedicated schools eWaste contractor.
2. Contract number / RFQ / purchase-order identifier.
3. Contract commencement date.
4. Contract expiry/extensions.
5. Whether the arrangement is under Contract 9826 or a separate procurement.
6. Current subcontractors for regional NSW collection.

Dubbo/Orana physical route

7. Which contractor collects from Dubbo public schools?
8. Where is equipment first taken after collection?
9. Is there a regional consolidation site?
10. First testing/refurbishment facility name/address.
11. First recycling facility name/address.
12. Whether any collected devices are processed through AMR, Sims, Sircel, WorkVentures, ACT Logistics or another provider.

Asset outcomes

13. Number of laptops/desktops collected from Dubbo/Orana public schools in:
 - 2023/24
 - 2024/25
 - 2025/26
14. Percentage/number:
 - reused/remarketed
 - donated
 - parts harvested
 - material recycled
 - physically destroyed.
15. Whether residual-value credits/sale proceeds are returned to Education/schools.

Data/security

16. Blank/redacted sanitisation certificate.
17. Sanitisation standard/method.
18. Whether SSD/NVMe/embedded storage is handled differently from HDDs.
19. Failed-drive physical-destruction process.
20. Chain-of-custody requirements.

Reporting

- 21. Blank/redacted Settlement Report.
- 22. Required asset-level fields.
- 23. Whether downstream recycling certificates are issued.

Reuse opportunities

- 24. Whether usable school laptops can be diverted to the NSW Device Bank.
- 25. Whether regional refurbishers can become subcontractors.
- 26. Whether Education would consider a Dubbo/Orana reuse-before-recycling pilot.

16. Contacts / information access

Public program contact in the eWaste guide:

cor0835r8406.schoolsinfra@det.nsw.edu.au

Department information-access material supports informal and formal GIPA requests where the information is not already public.

A formal GIPA request may involve the statutory application fee and processing rules.

17. What is VERIFIED vs UNKNOWN

VERIFIED

- NSW public schools use a dedicated Department eWaste contract.
- Schools request collections through the Department/EDConnect process.
- A public eWaste PowerApp/user guide exists.
- Schools inventory equipment and coordinate collection.
- The vendor creates cost-efficient collection schedules.
- Quantity estimates are used to arrange the right team/truck.
- The operational guide says school-side hard-drive wiping/destruction is no longer required, but its applicability and relationship to the current policy's pre-disposal wiping rule require Department clarification (EVD-DISPOSAL-023-024).
- Vendor sanitises all collected hard drives.
- Vendor provides sanitisation certificate.
- Vendor provides settlement report.
- Department policy permits redistribution of unused Department-allocated devices before disposal.
- Whole-of-government Contract 9826 allows reuse by sale/donation, supply-chain recovery, or third-party recycling.
- ACT Logistics, G1, Greenbox, Lifecycle Plus, Sims Lifecycle Services and WorkVentures are current standalone-service suppliers on C9826.
- NSW Device Bank refurbishes other surplus NSW Government laptops through WorkVentures.

UNKNOWN / NOT PUBLICLY VERIFIED

- current dedicated Education eWaste vendor name
- whether the Education contract is under C9826
- exact Dubbo collection contractor

- physical collection route from Dubbo
- first depot
- first refurbishment/testing facility
- first recycler
- whether AMR is involved
- whether Sircel is involved
- whether Sims is involved
- whether WorkVentures is involved
- whether ACT Logistics is involved
- whether school laptops enter NSW Device Bank
- percentage reused
- percentage resold
- percentage donated
- percentage recycled
- percentage destroyed
- residual-value payments
- exact contents of the Settlement Report.

These should remain labelled unknown until primary evidence closes them.

Primary sources

- NSW Department of Education — Technology in schools procedures
<https://education.nsw.gov.au/policy-library/policies/pd-2024-0481-01>
- NSW Department of Education — eWaste Application User Guide
<https://t4l.schools.nsw.gov.au/content/dam/doe/sws/schools/t/t4l/pdfs/DOE25-eWasteApplicationInstructions.pdf>
- Technology for Learning — Issue 122, eWaste backlog/process
<https://education.nsw.gov.au/teaching-and-learning/technology-for-learning/news-t4l/2025/issue122>
- NSW Government — ICT End User Devices and Services Contract 9826
<https://www.info.buy.nsw.gov.au/contracts/ict-end-user-devices-and-services>
- NSW Device Bank Pilot tender
<https://buy.nsw.gov.au/prcOpportunity/9A339589-49D9-448D-9A06E56260BBFA42>
- Example ACT Logistics NSW Government ITAD award (DPIRD; not Education proof)
<https://buy.nsw.gov.au/notices/08711EC5-DE37-4296-85BA5DE72801AE34>

Bottom line

For Dubbo public schools, the verified chain currently ends publicly at:

school → Department eWaste request → contracted vendor collection → vendor data sanitisation → sanitisation certificate + Settlement Report

Everything after that — reuse, resale, Device Bank, parts recovery, shredding, downstream recycler and physical destination — still needs the contractor/settlement-report evidence.

That is now the most important next question if Dubbo eWaste wants to understand or eventually participate in the public-school laptop stream.